ARTHĀPATTI : A CRITICAL AND COMPARATIVE STUDY OF THE VIEWS OF PŪRVA MĪMĀṀSA, ADVAITA VEDĀNTA AND NYĀYA – VAIŚEṢIKA SYSTEMS

Thesis Submitted to Sri Venkateswara University
for the Award of the Degree of
DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY IN PHILOSOPHY

BY
G. PRATHAPA SIMHA

UNDER THE GUIDANCE OF
Prof. M. VEERAIAH, M A., (Hons), Ph.D.
Department of Philosophy
S. V. UNIVERSITY COLLEGE
TIRUPATI

1989

CERTIFICATE

Dr. M.VEERAIAH, M.A., (Hons)., Ph.D.,
Professor of Philosophy,
Department of Philosophy,
Sri Venkateswara University
College of Arts & Sciences,
TIRUPATI-517 502, A.P., INDIA.

This is to certify that the thesis entitled "ARTHĀPATTI : A CRITICAL AND COMPARATIVE STUDY OF THE VIEWS OF PŪRVA MĪMĀṀSA, ADVAITA VEDĀNTA AND NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA SYSTEMS" submitted for the award of DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY IN PHILOSOPHY is a record of research work done by Sri G.PRATHAPA SIMHA during the period of study under my guidance and the thesis has not previously formed the basis for the award to the candidate of any Degree or Diploma or Associateship or Fellowship or any other similar title.

M.Veeraiah
(Prof. M.VEERAIAH)

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I express my deep sense of gratitude to my esteemed teacher and supervisor, Prof. M. Veeraiah, for his constant help and abiding interest in preparing and finalising this work.

I am highly beholden to my teacher Dr. C. Ramaiah, Professor of Philosophy, S.V.University, who has always evinced keen interest in working out and completing this thesis. I am equally grateful to my teacher Prof. G.S. Herbert, Retired Professor of Philosophy, S.V.University for his constant encouragement and useful suggestions.

I owe a debt of gratitude to the great scholars Prof. Ramanuja Tatacharya, Vice-Chancellor, Kendriya Sanskrit Vidyapeetha, Tirupati; Prof. Swaminatham, Professor, Kendriya Sanskrit Vidyapeetha, Calicut, for explaining difficult and intricate problems.

I am highly thankful to Dr. K. Vasudeva Reddy, Head of the Department of Philosophy, who has provided me with all the facilities in the department of Philosophy.

I also express my gratitude to the other faculty members of Philosophy and fellow research scholars for the help, encouragement and affection extended to me throughout.

I am also thankful to Mr. M.S.V. Kumar for typing the manuscript and to Mr. K.R. Gangadhar, for getting the thesis typed on Electronic typewriter.

It is my pleasant duty to acknowledge the great help rendered to me by my friend Mr. D. Ramakrishnaiah, Lecturer in Education. My sincere thanks are also due to Dr. G. Vedaparayana, Lecturer in Philosophy, S.V.U.College for going through the manuscripts and giving helpful suggestions.

My thanks are due to my family members, who have constantly encouraged me to complete the work.

Place: TIRUPATI

Date : 27-12-89

G. Prathapsimha

(G. PRATHAPA SIMHA)

C O N T E N T S

		Page No.
	INTRODUCTION	i - ix
CHAPTER I :	KNOWLEDGE, VALID KNOWLEDGE AND SOURCE OF VALID KNOWLEDGE	1 - 45
	A. The Nature of Knowledge (Jñāna)	7
	B. Pramā or Valid Knowledge	13
	C. Pramāṇa	30
	References	42
CHAPTER II :	THE NATURE AND FUNCTION OF ARTHĀPATTI	46 -111
	A. The Pūrva Mīmāṁsa Conception of Arthāpatti	52
	i. Kumārila Bhaṭṭa on Arthāpatti	52
	ii. Prabhākara on Arthāpatti	69
	B. Arthāpatti : The Conception of Advaita Vedānta	93
	References	109
CHAPTER III:	NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA ON ARTHĀPATTI	112 -185
	A. Gautama and Vātsyāyana on Arthāpatti	115
	B. Arthāpatti is a case of Samānya-todṛṣṭa inference : Uddyotakara's view	132
	C. Arthāpatti is not distinct from Anumāna : Jayanta Bhaṭṭa's view	142
	Criticism of Śrutarthāpatti	149

D. Arthāpatti indistinguishable from inference based on Kevala-vyatireki Vyāpti 157

Conclusion 180

References 182

CHAPTER IV : IN DEFENCE OF ARTHĀPATTI AS AN INDEPENDENT PRAMĀṆA 186 - 226

A. The contention of the Prabhākarās in defence of Arthāpatti 189

B. The defence of Advaita Vedānta 197

C. Kumārila's defence of Arthāpatti 208

Arthāpatti is different from Anumāna 210

References 225

CHAPTER V : A CRITICAL ESTIMATE 227 - 263

References 264

BIBLIOGRAPHY 265 - 276

INTRODUCTION

There is much difference of opinion among Indian Epistemologists as to what the ultimate sources of human knowledge are. For the Cārvākās, who are radical empiricists, Pratyakṣa or perception is the only valid source of knowledge and all valid knowledge comes from perception. The Buddhists and the Vaiśeṣikās hold that Pratyakṣa or perception and Anumāna or inference are the ultimate sources of valid knowledge. According to Sāṁkhya and the Yoga systems, Śabda or Verbal testimony also should be recognised as an independent source of knowledge like perception and inference. The Sāṁkhya includes Upamāna and Arthāpatti under inference, and Abhāva under perception. Naiyāyikās are in favour of the view that there are four independent sources of knowledge namely, perception, inference, verbal testimony and comparison. According to them, the other sources of knowledge namely Arthāpatti or presumption and Anupalabdhi or non-apprehension recognised by the systems of Mīmāṁsa and Vedānta may be included within these four and so need not be taken as ultimate or independent source of knowledge. The Prabhākarā school of Pūrva Mīmāṁsa adds Arthāpatti or presumption to the list of four pramāṇas admitted by Nyāya. The Bhaṭṭa school of Pūrva Mīmāṁsa and the Advaita school of Uttara Mīmāṁsa recognised the above five pramāṇas to the addition of

Anupalabdhi or non-apprehension. According to the Mīmāṁsa and Advaita Vedānta, Arthāpatti is a separate source of knowledge, because it gives us a knowledge of facts which cannot be otherwise explained. It cannot be explained by perception or inference. According to the Advaita Vedānta and Bhaṭṭa Mīmāṁsa, Anupalabdhi is an independent pramāṇa or ultimate source of knowledge. It is a unique cause of such a presentative knowledge of non-existence as is not due to inference or any other sources of knowledge.

It is, therefore, of immense importance for a student of Indian epistemology to probe into the question as to why different systems accept different number of pramāṇās. It is worthwhile to inquire whether the acceptance of the number of pramāṇās by a system is based on its ontological commitments or convictions. It is of course possible to compare any two or more systems accepting different number of pramāṇās and find out whether a system accepting more number of pramāṇās is commiting the fallacy of commission or the system accepting a lesser number of pramāṇās is commiting the fallacy of omission. In the present thesis, I have chosen "Arthāpatti" or postulation for my investigation. Arthāpatti has been accepted as a pramāṇa by the two schools of Pūrva Mīmāṁsa and Advaita Vedānta. On the other hand, the Buddhists, the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika

and the Sāṁkhya-Yoga refuse to accept Arthāpatti as a distinct way of knowing simply because they hold that it is reducible to inference. Jayanta Bhaṭṭa of Nyāya system, champions this group in the same way in which Kumārila Bhaṭṭa leads the opposite camp. Jayanta follows the conventional Nyāya line in rejecting Arthāpatti as a pramāṇa. Though his predecessors have also dealt with the problem, Jayanta's detailed, comprehensive and systematic treatment of Arthāpatti in his Nyāyamañjarī seems to have surpassed all previous accounts. Jayanta has convincingly proved the superiority of the Nyāya exposition against that of the Mīmāṁsa. It is perhaps for the first time that a triangular conflict between the Nyāya, Mīmāṁsa and Advaita regarding Arthāpatti has been brought to the surface and resolved with ingenious and erudite argumentation. Dharmarājadhavarindara of Advaita who has given a fair account of Arthāpatti, is posterior to Jayanta and none of the Vedāntins prior to him has thought it worthwhile to provide a systematic analysis of the problem. It follows that at the time of Jayanta, the main exponents of Arthāpatti were the Mīmāṁsakās. Thus, Jayanta Bhaṭṭa had to analyse this problem against the views of the Mīmāṁsakās. Jayanta ultimately refuses both the schools of Pūrva Mīmāṁsa contending that since Arthāpatti is reducible to inference, it is not an independent pramāṇa or a distinct way of knowing.

The whole problem of Arthāpatti in Indian Philosophy, therefore, ultimately revolves around mainly the two schools of Pūrva Mīmāṁsa and Advaita Vedānta on the one hand and the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika on the other, the central issue being whether Arthāpatti is an independent pramāṇa distinct from inference or it is something which can be reduced to inference thereby losing its identity and distinctness as an independent pramāṇa. The present researcher contemplates, to start with the elucidation of the nature of Arthāpatti as conceived by the two schools of Pūrva Mīmāṁsa and Advaita Vedānta by whom it has been accepted as a pramāṇa. Secondly, the dissertation contemplates to probe into the respective arguments of these schools to vouch for its distinctness from Anumāna or inference. Thirdly, it is proposed to inquire into the validity of the Nyāya attempts with special reference to Jayanta Bhaṭṭa, to reduce it to Anumāna pramāṇa. This is the three-fold task which the present researcher has as his main responsibility.

As the literature of each of the systems is very vast, it has compelled us to limit the study to the selected works of each of the systems. As regards the selection of the sources, the texts which are of basic importance and have constructive value are selected for the present study. I have selected as far as possible the sūtrās, the bhāṣyās, and the vārtikās as well as some celebrated

works of each system. The selection of these texts is prompted by the consideration that the sūtrās represent the seeds of the thought, the bhāṣyās and the vārtikās indicate their development into a discipline in the form of concrete and possible criticism and the celebrated works offer a picture of a full-fledged system. The celebrated works of different systems consulted here are the manuals which contain the elaboration or compendium of what has been said in original texts of the systems. It has not been our aim to settle the chronological controversies. The latest accepted views regarding the age of the texts has been generally followed. The works of modern scholars are also consulted for a clearer and critical presentation of the subject matter.

The discussions and controversies regarding the nature and status of Arthāpatti cover a wide range of problems. Therefore, a definite arrangement is followed in writing this dissertation. The thesis is prepared in five chapters.

In the first chapter entitled "Knowledge, Valid knowledge and Source of Valid knowledge" the theories of different schools of Indian Philosophy regarding the nature of knowledge (jñāna), the criterion of valid knowledge (pramā) and the means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), are discussed in brief. Regarding the essential nature

of knowledge, the three main conceptions advocated by the different schools of Indian Philosophy are explained. The Nyāya view, that the knowledge is an attribute (Guṇa) of the self, the Sāṁkhya-Yoga view of knowledge as a substantive modification of buddhi and the Bauddha and the Mīmāṁsa view that knowledge is an activity (Karma), a transitive process have been discussed.

It is generally admitted by the schools of Indian Philosophy that pramā is true or valid knowledge. There is, however, a difference of opinion between the schools regarding the test of validity itself. Hence the several definitions of pramā as offered by the different systems are clearly explained. The views of the Nyāya, the Vaiśe-ṣika, the Mīmāṁsa, the Bauddha, the Sāṁkhya and the Jaina views of pramāṇa are critically explained.

The third part of discussion is devoted to the theories of pramāṇa or the means of valid knowledge. All the systems of Indian Philosophy agree in respect of the literal meaning as well as the function or the purpose of pramāṇa that it is conducive to the attainment of valid knowledge. There is, however, divergence of opinion about the exact nature of Kāraṇa of valid knowledge. A Kāraṇa is generally conceived as a special cause in producing a particular effect. The criterion of Kāraṇa, however, is variously interpreted by different systems. The views

of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣikās, the Bauddha, the Jaina, the Mīmāṁsa, the Sāṁkhya-Yoga and the Advaita Vedānta are presented.

The second chapter, "The Nature and Function of Arthāpatti", is devoted to a critical discussion of the traditional issue of the nature and scope of our knowledge claims by means of Arthāpatti or postulation. The three views on the nature of Arthāpatti are considered as they stand. These are 1) Bhaṭṭa's view that Arthāpatti is a means of resolving a conflict; 2) Prabhākarā's view that Arthāpatti involves an element of doubt; and 3) Advaita Vedānta interpretation that Arthāpatti is an explanation of an otherwise inexplicable fact. Kumārila and Prabhākarā of Pūrva Mīmāṁsa, though both depend on Śabara Bhāṣya regarding Arthāpatti, interpreted the pramāṇa in their own distinct ways. Arthāpatti is a valid and independent source of knowledge for both the schools. But Prabhākarā's view of Arthāpatti is just the reverse of Kumārila's. Sincere attempt has been made to understand these contrasting views of Arthāpatti and to highlight the salient features of Kumārila's and Prabhākarā's interpretations of Śabara Bhāṣya in respect of Arthāpatti. The stand point of Advaita Vedānta which advocates Arthāpatti as an independent source of cognition, may be said to differ from Prabhākarā and be in agreement with Kumārila in not recognizing 'doubt' as an element in this source of cognition.

Even so, it understands presumption in a way different from that in which the Mīmāṁsa understands it, although it may be that their separate understandings ultimately amount to one and the same thing. The Advaita Vedāntist view of presumption differs from that of the Mīmāṁsa in making no mention of such a thing as the conflict between two known facts and consequently, being unconcerned with the idea of the resolution of the conflict of this description. In the view of the Advaita Vedānta, there is only one fact which is said to be well known namely, that something presents itself to be inexplicable or stands unexplained and so is in need of explanation. This points to the function, the performance of which is the very essence of Arthāpatti.

The third chapter is "Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika on Arthāpatti". It is well known that the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika system which accepts only four pramāṇas does not regard Arthāpatti as an independent pramāṇa, although it does not cast any aspersions on the bonafides of Arthāpatti as a valid source of cognition. All said and done, the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika stand point is that Arthāpatti is a case of Anumāna or inference. The whole burden of this chapter is the presentation of the different shades of this Nyāya stand point expressed in the course of the history of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika logic. The views of Gautama and Vātsyāyana that Arthāpatti is the same as anvaya-vyāpti; Uddyotakara's view that Arthāpatti is a case of Sāmānyatodraṣṭa inference; Jayanta

Bhaṭṭa's view that Arthāpatti in any of its forms, is identical with inference and finally the view of the latter Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika logicians that Arthāpatti is indistinguishable from Anumāna based on Kevala Vyatirekivyāpti or purely negative concomitance, have all been explained in considerable depth and details.

The fourth chapter is captioned "In Defence of Arthāpatti as an Independent Pramāṇa". In the face of the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika onslaughts on the independent status of Arthāpatti, it behoves on the propents of Arthāpatti to extricate the pramāṇa under consideration from these onslaughts and attain for it an independent and irreducible character beyond all shadow of doubt and suspicion. In short the entire burden of the Mīmāṁsa, Advaita Vedānta systems is to prove that Arthāpatti is different from and other than Anumāna. The present chapter is an effort in this regard. The contributions of Kumārila, Prabhākarā and Advaita Vedānta have been dealt with in separate sections.

In the fifth and the last chapter "A Critical Estimate", the views of the present researcher in favour of the Mīmāṁsa-Advaita Vedānta conception of Arthāpatti is an independent pramāṇa have been attempted.

At the end a comprehensive bibliography is appended.